

Although, these aren't very effective, because hackers always find new ways to bypass all of that. They just tweak their hacks a bit, and make it undetectable to the new standard, and voila, their hacks are good to go, for a few months, at least.

Valve got scent of this, a year or so ago, and introduced a new way of convicting hackers in Counter Strike: Global Offensive. They rolled out Overwatch. They rolled out Overwatch. Now, Overwatch takes help of the community, something which Valve is famous for doing. What it does is, whenever someone is reported for cheating in a competitive match of CS:GO, Valve sends a video of the match, from the perspective of the suspected hacker to someone on the Overwatch community, which consists of experienced players, and professionals. The Overwatch community then reviews the video, and decides whether or not the suspect had an unfair advantage over the opposition, or if the suspect was just a very good player. It's more effective than VAC, because player perspective would give away undetectable hacks very easily.

Some developers went and even decided to have fun with some of these hackers. Rockstar games decided to give hackers a taste of their own medicine. If you were convicted of cheating on Max Payne 3 multiplayer server, your account would be blacklisted, and you'd only be allowed to be matched up with other convicted hackers, in a "cheaters pool" of sorts. Now, hacking against other hackers is kind of pointless. So, you're constantly stuck in a loop of never dying, even though you're hit by a million rockets, and other people who never died either, and had unlimited ammo, and no reload hacks. If you were nice enough to apologize to Rockstar, they'd allow you to be pulled out of the cheater's pool. Although, if you were convicted of hacking again, you'd be permanently banned.

AFTERMATH

If you were wondering what it's like, getting banned, look no further. Well, mostly because nothing much happens. Your copy of the game becomes obsolete, and you're only



allowed to play if you buy another copy of the game. Or in case of Steam, only if you buy it from a different account.

As of today, there isn't much to deter hackers from hacking, at all. Permanent bans are easily bypassable, if you buy another copy of the game.

Getting a VAC ban is the gaming equivalent of being thrown into Davey Jones' locker. Only, it's easy to buy your way out of it, if you just buy another copy of the game.

The gaming community, at large, has been baying for blood, about how easy it is, for a hacker to return to a game. If they're banned on one copy of the game, or on one account, they could just easily make another account, or buy another copy of the game, and they're back. There's many theories explaining exactly why many developers won't introduce a permanent way of making sure hackers stay out of a game, or at least make sure that it isn't

easy for them to return to a game in which they've been convicted of hacking. One of the major speculations being, developers do it to keep up their sales. A hacker who has been convicted is

forced to buy another account, and another copy of the game, which ensures that the sales of the game don't stop. It's backed by the fact that after a massive VAC ban wave, in 2014, CS:GO sales rocketed. Which meant that all the hackers that got banned, just went and bought another copy of the game.

Personally, we, at Skoar, really liked the community run servers in CS 1.6, where the Admin would take prompt action against suspected hackers, and kick them from the server. In games like CS:GO, you'd have to play an entire match, even if the hacker is up to his mischief since round one, lest you get a matchmaking cooldown.

WHY YOU SHOULDN'T BE HACKING

Well, if you've ever played against a hacker, you'd know. But just to drive the point home, it ruins everyone else's game as well. You're fuelling potentially criminal hackers, who wouldn't think twice before wiping your bank balance clean, if they thought they could get away with it. You're also turning away millions of people away from playing competitively, and finally, you're a massive, massive butt, if you hack or cheat. *